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14. Customs Clearance

The exporter or his agent prepares three copies of shipping bill in printed form. The shipping bill contains the details like name and address of exporter, description of goods, value of goods, volume of goods, identification marks on the goods, port of destination and port of loading.

There are three types of shipping bills for three different categories of goods namely, dutiable goods, duty-free goods and duty draw-back goods Forwarding agent proceeds to pay of export duty calculated by customs officers in the case of dutiable goods.

i. Payment of Dock Dues

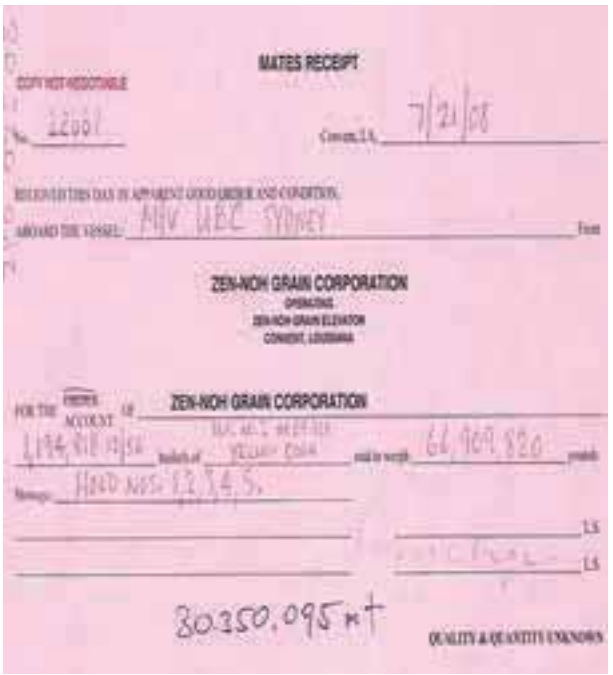
After the payment of export duty, the forwarding agent arranges for transporting the goods to docks. The agent fills two copies of challan and submits it to the dock authorities along with one copy of shipping bill. Then the agent pays dock charges. Dock authorities retain one copy of challan and return the second copy to the forwarding agent. This signed copy is called Dock Receipt or Port Trust Receipt.

ii. Obtaining Permission for Shipment

The forwarding agent brings the consignment over to the dock. The Customs Preventive Officer stationed at the docks inspects the goods on the basis of declaration in the shipping bill. This officer gives permission to load the goods onto board by issuing Customs Export Pass or simply makes an endorsement with wordings 'Let Ship' on the duplicate copy of shipping bill.

iii. Mate's Receipt

Mate's Receipt is the document issued by the captain of the ship acknowledging the receipt of goods on board by him to the port of specified destination. This contains details like quantity of goods shipped, number of packages condition for packing. etc., Where the Mate is satisfied with packing he/she issues clean receipt. If he/she is not satisfied with packing, he/she issues foul receipt. Forwarding agent should seek to get clean receipt. Otherwise insurance company will not bear liability for loss in case of foul receipt.


MATES RECEIPT

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iv. Bill of Lading

Bill of Lading, refers to a document signed by ship owner or to his agent mentioning that goods specified have been received and it would be delivered to the importer or his agent at the port of destination if good condition subject to terms and conditions mentioned therein.